

CHICKASAW TRIBAL LEGISLATURE
Permanent Resolution Number 20-026
Amendments to title 7, Chapter 2 of the Chickasaw Nation Code
(The Chickasaw Nation Scholarship Program)

WHEREAS, in accordance with Article VII, Sections 4 and 7 of the Constitution of the Chickasaw Nation, the Chickasaw Tribal Legislature shall enact rules and regulations pertaining to the Chickasaw Nation, and shall make decisions pertaining to the acquisition, leasing, disposition and management of real property, subject to federal law, and

WHEREAS, in accordance with Article XI, Section 1 of the Constitution of the Chickasaw Nation, the Governor shall perform all duties appertaining to the Office of Chief Executive. He shall sign official papers on behalf of the Nation, and

WHEREAS, the Chickasaw Tribal Legislature recognizes that providing an opportunity for Chickasaw students to attain higher education is of the highest priority and worthy of enthusiastic governmental support, and

WHEREAS, the Legislature has previously dissolved the Education Foundation and placed all Foundation scholarship programs in the Division of Education, and

WHEREAS, the Legislature desires to streamline the delivery of grants and scholarships to Chickasaw students.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED, that the Chickasaw Tribal Legislature hereby repeals Article 7, Chapter 2, Sections 7-201 thru 7-232 entitled "Education" and Chapter 3, Section 7-301 entitled "Student Loan Program" in their entirety and replaces said sections with the following (additions are shown in red and deletions are stricken through):

"SECTION 7-201.1 TITLE.

Be it enacted by the Chickasaw Tribal Legislature here assembled that this Act be cited as the "Chickasaw Nation Scholarship Program Act" ("Act").

SECTION 7-201.2 EFFECTIVE DATE.

This Act shall become effective beginning with the Fall semester of the 2004-2005 school year and shall be continued thereafter. Between the passage of this Act and the Fall semester of the 2004-2005 school year, the current programs shall be honored and completed for the 2003-2004 school year under the relevant programs, procedures and agreements that existed at the time of award to the student.

SECTION 7-201.3 **PURPOSE.**

The purpose of this Act shall be to promote excellence in higher education among Chickasaw students by rewarding achievement, consolidating and streamlining the application process, providing flexibility in the assignment of scholarship funds according to the needs of each school year and promoting clarity in the selection and award process.

SECTION 7-201.4 **PROFESSIONAL STUDIES SCHOLARSHIP.**

A. **Summary.** The Professional Studies Scholarship (“PSS”) is intended to assist students by providing tuition, room and board, a stipend and books for those pursuing careers in the fields of architecture, interior design, mathematics, science, engineering, law, health, business and other fields as determined by the Education Division according to student needs of each school year. The PSS has a service requirement upon graduation.

B. **Service Repayment.** Students receiving PSS scholarships shall be required to sign an agreement with the Chickasaw Nation stating 1) they shall repay all funds accepted through the PSS Scholarship, or 2) that for each year they receive the scholarship they agree to work one (1) year, up to a maximum of two (2) years, for the Chickasaw Nation (“Service Repayment”). Upon the completion of the Service Repayment, the entire amount owed shall be forgiven.

C. **Forgiveness.** Upon graduation of a student who had received a PSS scholarship and agreed to service repayment, should no appropriate position exist with the Chickasaw Nation, The Governor, within his discretion, may forgive the debt.

D. **Determination of Amount.** The amount of scholarship funding shall be determined on an individual basis with consideration given to the field of study and the financial aid package provided by the student’s academic institution.

SECTION 7-201.5 **GENERAL SCHOLARSHIP PROGRAM; CRITERIA FOR SELECTION.**

A. **Summary.** The General Scholarship Program (“GSP”) is intended to award specific dollar amounts to students based on their class standing and academic achievement as reflected by their semester grade point average.

B. **Formula.** Funding levels shall be calculated using a formula which will take into consideration the student’s grade point average, classification level (whether undergraduate or graduate), whether full- or part-time, and available funds. The formula and information regarding award amounts shall be made available to the Governor’s office, the Legislature and the public annually.

SECTION 7-201.633

CLOTHING GRANTS.

A. The Chickasaw Nation Tribal Legislature authorizes and approves a \$400.00 per academic year clothing grant for Chickasaw students who are attending undergraduate, postgraduate or vocational/technical institutions of higher education.

B. A Chickasaw student is eligible for one (1) clothing grant per academic year (i.e., one (1) as a freshman, one (1) as a sophomore, etc.) which may be paid in two (2) increments during said academic year.

C. The funding for the grants shall be allocated from the Railroad Station Grounds Clothing Grant funds line item. If necessary, funding for this grant may be supplemented from the tribal general fund. This is to be implemented in the Fall of 2001.

SECTION 7-234 — RESERVED.

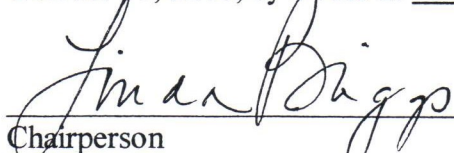
SECTION 7-235 — RESERVED.

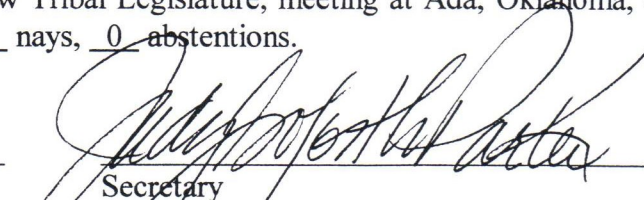
SECTION 7-201.736

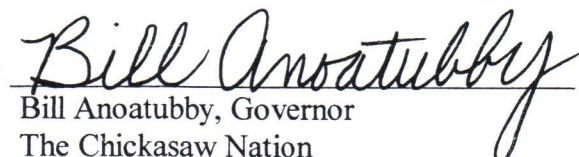
**ESTABLISHING \$1,000 "MILLENNIUM SCHOLARSHIP"
FOR GRADUATING CHICKASAW SENIORS.**

The Chickasaw Tribal Legislature hereby approves a one thousand dollar (\$1,000.00) scholarship (five hundred dollars (\$500) per semester or functional equivalent) to be awarded to a maximum of fifty (50) Chickasaw graduating seniors each year when they enroll in their first year of full-time study at either an accredited college, university or vo-tech or other approved course(s) of study/job training. First preference will be given to those students who are not eligible for Federal Grants, then other students. The amount of fifty thousand dollars (\$50,000) will be appropriated every year. If there are less than fifty (50) students, remaining funds will be carried over and distributed in following years. This program is to commence in the Fall semester of 2001 to be taken from tribal funds, non-trust.

Executed in regular session of the Chickasaw Tribal Legislature, meeting at Ada, Oklahoma, on October 17, 2003, by a vote of 9 ayes, 4 nays, 0 abstentions.


Chairperson
Chickasaw Tribal Legislature


Secretary
Chickasaw Tribal Legislature

Concur: 
Bill Anoatubby, Governor
The Chickasaw Nation

Date: OCT 17 2003

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(The Chickasaw Nation Scholarship Program)

Explanation: This resolution repeals certain sections of Title 7, Chapter 2 of the Chickasaw Nation Code regarding scholarship programs for Chickasaw students. This resolution also establishes a comprehensive scholarship program with the intention to promote excellence in higher education among Chickasaw students by rewarding achievement, consolidating and streamlining the application process, providing flexibility in the assignment of scholarship funds according to the needs of each school year and promoting clarity in the selection and award process.

Requested By: Dr. Judy Goforth Parker
Education Committee

Presented By: Wanda Blackwood Scott, Chairperson